

Possessions

Unit 2 of 12 · Grammar Study Sheet

Describe rooms, talk about objects you own, and shop in English.

What you will be able to do

- ✓ Talk about furniture and objects in the house
- ✓ Use there is / there are
- ✓ Use prepositions of place
- ✓ Make singular and plural nouns
- ✓ Use this, that, these, those
- ✓ Say currencies, countries and nationalities
- ✓ Ask about and buy objects in a shop

4 lessons in this unit

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Lesson 2a · A place called home

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Topics: furniture · there is/are · prepositions of place

Vocabulary — Furniture

sofa	armchair	chair	television (TV)
desk	lamp	computer	pictures
blinds	curtains	cupboards and drawers	rug
plant	carpet	shelves	

The four families live in the Evergreen Tower in Seoul, South Korea. Every apartment has a living room, kitchen, bathroom and 2 bedrooms.

there is / there are

Use "there is/are" to say what exists in a place. Singular → there is. Plural → there are. Use "any" with negatives and questions.

+	There's a living room. / There are two bedrooms.
—	There isn't a table. / There aren't any beds.
?	Is there a sofa? — Yes, there is. / Are there any pictures? — No, there aren't.

Examples:

- There's a sofa on the right.
- There are pictures on the wall.
- There isn't a rug in this apartment.
- Are there any books? — No, there aren't.
- How many pictures are there? — There are three.

Prepositions of place

Tell where things are in relation to other things.

Examples:

- in (the box) — inside
- on (the desk) — touching the top
- next to (the bed) — beside
- under (the table) — below
- above (the door) — higher, not touching
- between (X and Y) — in the middle of two things
- behind (the sofa) — at the back of
- in front of (the window) — directly before
- opposite (the TV) — facing
- on the left / on the right / in the middle

Lesson 2b · My possessions

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Topics: useful objects · plural nouns · this/that/these/those · /■/ or /i■/

Vocabulary — Useful objects

boots	bottle	camera	first-aid kit
gloves	hat	knife	map
mobile phone	pens	torch	

Andy Torbet is a Scottish adventurer who climbs, dives and kayaks. These are the things in his rucksack.

Pronunciation — /■/ vs /i■/

Two similar vowel sounds. /■/ is SHORT (this, big, pink, it). /i■/ is LONG (these, keys, green, read).

- /■/ — this, big, pink, it
- /i■/ — these, keys, green, read
- Listen for length: /i■/ is held longer than /■/.

Plural nouns — spelling rules

Most nouns add -s. Special rules for words ending in -ch/-sh/-s, -y, -f/-fe. Some are irregular.

+s	normal: boot → boots, glove → gloves
+es	sh, s, ch, x, ss, z — torch → torches, bus → buses, class → classes, box → boxes, buzz → buzzes. M■o: "sháng say, chi■u x■n, sung s■ng, zô"
-ies	consonant + -y: country → countries, family → families
-ves	-f/-fe: knife → knives, shelf → shelves, life → lives
irreg.	man → men, woman → women, person → people, child → children, foot → feet, tooth → teeth, mouse → mice

Examples:

- one map → two maps
- one mobile phone → two mobile phones
- one camera → two cameras
- one life → two lives
- one wife → two wives
- one city → two cities

this, that, these, those

Demonstratives change with NUMBER (singular/plural) and DISTANCE (near/far).

near sing.	this (one thing near you)
far sing.	that (one thing away from you)

near plur.	these (many things near you)
far plur.	those (many things away from you)

Examples:

- What's this? — It's a first-aid kit.
 - What's that? — It's my camera.
 - What are these? — They're my pens.
 - What are those? — They're Andy's gloves.
 - Is this torch Andy's? / Are those your boots?
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Lesson 2c · Global objects

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Topics: countries and nationalities · word stress · suffixes

Vocabulary — Countries and nationalities

Britain → British	Germany → German	Austria → Austrian	Netherlands → Dutch
Canada → Canadian	Italy → Italian	Belgium → Belgian	England → English
Spain → Spanish	France → French	Brazil → Brazilian	Poland → Polish
Vietnam → Vietnamese			

Common nationality endings: *-ish* (Polish, Spanish), *-n* (Italian, German), *-ian* (Canadian, Brazilian), *-ese* (Vietnamese, Japanese, Chinese). Some are irregular: *French, Dutch*.

Pronunciation — Word stress in nationalities

Most country/nationality words are stressed on the FIRST syllable. Words ending in *-ese* are stressed on the LAST syllable.

- BRItain / BRItish (first syllable)
- iTAlian / aMErican (second syllable)
- japaNESE / vietnaMESE / portuGUESE (last syllable, *-ese* ending)

The Mini — a global product

A car can be "from" different places: company, parts, factory. This shows globalisation.

Examples:

- The Mini was a British car until 2000.
- BMW (German) is the producer now.
- The factory is still in Oxford, England.
- There are 2,500 parts from many different countries (Europe + North America).

Lesson 2d · Shopping + adverts + photos

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Topics: prices and currencies · shopping · word focus: one/ones · contrastive stress · adjectives · adjective order · writing adverts · video lesson · a thousand words

Vocabulary — Prices and currencies (2d)

£ pounds (UK)	\$ dollars (USA)	€ euros (EU)	¥ yen (Japan)
£2.50 = two pounds fifty	£111.11 = a hundred and eleven pounds eleven		

Common shopping phrases: "Can I help you?" / "I'd like..." / "How much is it?" / "Are there other colours?" / "These ones are red." / "How much are they?"

Vocabulary — Adjectives and their opposites (2e)

old ↔ modern/new	bad ↔ good	useless ↔ useful	slow ↔ fast
small ↔ big/large	expensive ↔ cheap		

Vocabulary — Video — Key phrases (2f)

I miss you	Please forward	Good luck!	apartment
bicycle	box	cake	camera
lamp	letterbox	package	pen
plant			

"A picture says a thousand words." A photographer in Los Angeles sends his camera to Nasim in Boston.

Pronunciation — Contrastive stress (1) (2d)

When you contrast two things with this/that/these/those, STRONG stress on the demonstrative highlights the difference.

- This ball is nice, but THAT one is horrible!
- These gloves are small, but THOSE ones are large.

Word focus: one / ones (2d)

Use "one" / "ones" to AVOID repeating a noun. Singular → one. Plural → ones.

Examples:

- I'd like a glass of water. A small ONE, please. (= a small glass)
- I'd like two T-shirts. Small ONES, please. (= small T-shirts)
- This ball is nice, but that ONE is horrible.
- These gloves are small, but those ONES are large.

Writing skill — Adjective order (2e)

When using multiple adjectives, follow this order: OPINION → SIZE → AGE → COLOUR → NATIONALITY → NOUN.

Opinion	useful, nice, lovely, beautiful
Size	large, small

Age	modern, new, old
Colour	white, grey, red
Nation.	Japanese, Italian, French

Examples:

- It's a fast, new, Japanese motorbike. (opinion + age + nationality)
- A useful, modern, white desk and chair. (opinion + age + colour)
- They're lovely red gloves. (opinion + colour)
- There are two beautiful, old, Italian chairs for sale.
- For sale: a large, modern, white house.

Two patterns to describe (2e)

You can describe an object in two ways with the same meaning.

Examples:

- The desk is modern. = It's a modern desk.
 - The car is old. = It's an old car.
 - These laptops are slow. = They're slow laptops.
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